

The most important remedy for the difficulties in our country and abroad: prayer.

There are terrible things going on in Ukraine, and in the country of the United States. In the former, there is war, bloodshed and orphans and the threat of schism and heresy. In our country, we are seeing a breakdown of the political process which may increase lawlessness in our population and our governmental structures. Our bishops are well aware of these problems, and they have proposed the best solution. Opinions are cheap, but prayer is what is needful.

We have been directed to add to petitions to the Augmented litany in liturgy, and also a prayer for both Ukraine and the United States after this litany. These are to be said after every liturgy. In our parish, in an average week we serve at least two liturgies and therefore say these prayers two times each.

Please read the prayers carefully, and if you are so inclined, add petitions and or the prayer to your daily rule.

Also, you should be praying for those who are undergoing terrible circumstances. In the Ukraine there is bloodshed, but this is not the only place in the world where people are dying and being tortured. In Syria even now, people are being tortured because of their faith. This is happening in other places also.

We are seeing the subject of sexual abuse brought up, by those who are sincere, and also by those who want to use it as a political football. No matter who is right or wrong, lying or telling the truth, mistaken or remembering correctly, the fact is that in our country and all over the world women, and children and also men are being abused. Most of these people are suffering without any justice in this world. Many of them also are severely traumatized, and suffering from various psychological and physical problems because of their abuse, and some of them have the greatest problem, that they cannot forgive. You should also pray for those who are suffering because of abuse, sexual abuse, slavery, sexual slavery, drug addiction, PTSD, mental illness, demon possession, and every other affliction that might come to your mind. If we are Christians we pray for those who are suffering. If we only have opinions, but do not pray we are not Christians.

<http://www.orthodox.net/trebnic/petitions-preservation-orthodox-unity+prayer-for-peace-in-ukraine-america.pdf>

<http://www.orthodox.net/trebnic/petitions-preservation-orthodox-unity+prayer-for-peace-in-ukraine-america.doc>

<http://www.orthodox.net/trebnic/petitions-preservation-orthodox-unity+prayer-for-peace-in-ukraine-america-rus.pdf>

Petitions for the Preservation of Orthodox Unity

Approved by the Holy Synod ROC

September 1/14, 2018

<http://www.orthodox.net/trebnic/petitions-preservation-orthodox-unity+prayer-for-peace-in-ukraine-america.pdf>

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To be said at the Augmented Litany at all Divine Liturgies in the Diocese until further notice.

Again, we pray to our Lord and Saviour, that He might preserve the Orthodox Church throughout the world in unity and piety, and grant unto Her peace and tranquility, love and accord, let us all say, O Lord, hearken and have mercy.

Again, we pray, that He might look down upon the Holy Orthodox Church with kind-heartedness and mercy, and preserve Her from divisions and schisms, from enmity and strife, that Her unity might be neither diminished nor shaken, but that in Her Thy Thrice-Holy name might be glorified, let us all say, O Lord, hearken and have mercy.

Special Prayer for Peace in the Ukrainian and American lands

Prayer for the avoidance of civil war in the Ukrainian land and for peace in the American land

To be said after the augmented litany at all Divine Liturgies in the diocese until further notice.

Let us pray to the Lord!

O Lord Jesus Christ our God, look down with Thy merciful eye upon the sorrow and greatly-painful cry of Thy children, abiding in the Ukrainian land.

Deliver Thy people from civil strife, make to cease the spilling of blood, and turn back the misfortunes set against them. Lead unto sanctuary those bereft of shelter, feed the hungry, comfort those who weep, and unite the divided.

Do Thou calm the agitation and discord in our American land, banish from us slander and conflict, murder and drunkenness, bitter disputes and scandals, and burn out of our hearts every impurity, conflict and evil, that again we all may love one another and abide, as one, in Thee, O Lord, our God, as Thou has commanded and directed us.

Leave not Thy own flock, who abide in sorrows on account of their kinsmen, to diminish, but rather, as Thou art benevolent, give speedy reconciliation. Soften the hearts of the unmerciful and convert them to the knowledge of Thee. Grant peace to Thy Church and to Her children, that with one heart and one mouth we may glorify Thee, our Lord and Savior, unto the ages of ages. Amen.